

Get more done in less time using your keyboard

There are many keyboard shortcuts that make working with computers simpler and faster. There are some simple keystrokes that are as handy as [Ctrl] + [C] and [Ctrl] + [V] when it comes to operating computers.

Here is a very short list of handy Windows key shortcuts. The [Windows] + [E] lets you open Explorer, [Windows] + [D] displays the desktop, [Windows] + [M] minimises all windows, and [Windows] + [R] opens the run dialogue.

What exactly is attacking my computer?

When it comes to security threats, it's no longer as simple as a virus. There are many kinds of malware that attack your machine. Here is a quick look at what they are and what they do.

Virus

A program that piggybacks on other files, and spreads with malicious intent, these are actually uncommon now

Common sources: public computers, flash memory, LAN

Solution: Use a security suite

Worm

Unlike a virus, a worm can spread without attaching itself to files. It is also programmed to change itself, making variants more difficult to detect. Sometimes worms are updated remotely.

Common sources: LAN, email

Solution: Update the system and anti-virus, use a firewall, track security patches

Trojan

A Trojan is a software that pretends to work for you, but is actually doing something else, being a part of a botnet or allowing for unauthorised access.

Common sources: torrents, suspicious downloads, web sites

Solution: be careful of what you download



Exploit

An exploit is an inherent "hole" in an operating system or software, that allows malware such as Trojans or viruses to spread

Common sources: The base operating system, installed software (such as office suites)

Solution: keep your system and applications updated

The Jargon File

• **Benchmark:** A software for testing a particular piece of hardware. A graphic card benchmark would render a lot of polygons and effects. A CPU benchmark would feed in a lot of calculations, and so on.

• **Distro:** A distro is a distribution, or flavor of the Linux operating system. Common Linux distros include Ubuntu, OpenSuse and Fedora.

• **Ethical Hacker:** An ethical hacker is someone who finds out possible weaknesses in a network or a system before the bad guys do.

• **GUI:** A GUI, pronounced Gooley, stands for Graphical User Interface, which is a set of buttons, windows, panels and other devices for users to interact with a machine using a mouse and a keyboard, or other input devices.

• **MID:** Mobile Internet Device, can be a Mobile Phone with internet access, or a netbook. PMPs that interface with wireless networks are not MIDs. Any device that allows significant activity on various web sites is an MID.

It's not just a laptop anymore: a lowdown on portable computer form factors

Laptop: a device that serves either as a desktop replacement or a portable gaming rig.

Characteristics: Large screen, full QWERTY keyboard, good system.



Notebook: It is usually sleek and light, but bulkier than a netbook. Used for documents and presentations.

Characteristics: Sleek and lightweight, large screen.



Tablet: A Tablet is like a digital slate, with a full touch-screen surface, and no keyboard.

Characteristics: Is basically a large touchscreen



Netbook: a small and lightweight device meant for the internet and the cloud, for people on the go.

Characteristics: Small size, lightweight, long battery life



Smartbook: Has a range of connectivity options, a hybrid between a smartphone and a notebook.

Characteristics: Connectivity options, lightweight, long battery life



UMPC: Stands for Ultra Mobile PC, a tablet with a sliding keyboard, speakers or other peripherals.

Characteristics: Lack of a folding screen, low processing power

